

You said it...



Request for articles



I have been a regular reader of *LFY* for the last three months. I find the content and presentation really good (the DVD content included). I have just started out in the Linux world and follow the articles for admins regularly. In the December 2009 issue, you had mentioned that Nagios was covered in detail in December 2007. I would like to request you to send me a PDF of that article. Also, I would like to know whether Openfiler and Zmanda have been covered earlier.

—**Debojyoti Gope**, gope.debojyoti@gmail.com

ED: Glad to hear that you find the content useful. By the time you read this issue, we hope you'd have already read the Nagios article sent to you. As for the other two topics you wanted to know about, well, although we've not covered either, we'll definitely try to do so in the coming months.



I'm a regular reader of your publication. I had mailed you earlier about including free computer e-books on programming languages, networking, operating systems and security, if possible, on a DVD, along with the various operating systems and FOSS products you provide—since those are any techie's real requirements.

I sincerely believe you guys should include a valuable column by a reputed software professional, about how to make money, and subsequently a good living, as an open source developer. I have always wondered how one can make money through open source. If one works hard to build software and then goes on to open source its code, where would the remuneration come from to support a family? I don't understand how open source developers earn their bread and butter.

—**Bonny Davis**, Haryana.davisbonny@gmail.com

ED: Thanks for a detailed mail. I guess you've hit the nail on the head. A column/article addressing your concerns will not only help you, but could also guide many students/software professionals to consider FOSS seriously. We'll definitely work this out in the coming months.

Replies to an earlier post, titled: "We don't deserve the pride of being open"



Here is my reply to Vaibhav Kaushal's letter published in the January 2010 issue.

I find his experiences highly one-sided. There are many occasions in my professional career when I've faced precisely the opposite kind of situation. Take my graphical software SWISHMAX, which works fine on Windows. But on numerous occasions it halts because of viruses, et al. For the last two years, I have booted into Linux and worked on SWISHMAX

using Wine, without fear of viruses, slow downs, hang ups, etc.

As for antivirus software for Windows—let's just say, I'm thoroughly sick of it! Internet Explorer 5, 5.5, 6 and 7 are all slow and bulky. Firefox on Linux does everything that IE does on Windows. And it is fast and efficient on all counts.

The other day, one of my assistants made a DOCX and XLSX file on Office 2007. His presentation failed to open on an earlier MS Office package. The lecture session almost fell flat, right in the presence of a waiting audience; thankfully, I could open those two files on OpenOffice.org 3.1.1 on my Mandriva 2009 laptop. It shows that an OOo can do what earlier versions of MS Office failed to notice.

All my websites have run without any problems since the last five years on LAMP platforms. This includes one LAMP stack that's run since 2005 on FC-3. Had it been on IIS, I would not have had the time to write this letter.

The MF Frontpage is a good package for learning Web page designing. But for a professional Web page, you have to throw it into a dustbin and use Bluefish or Textmaker.

PHP is a lot faster and sleeker than the .NET or VB Script—don't take my word for it; check it yourself.

Even my organisation, which is a happy user of Windows since many years, relies on Linux to run its e-mail server on Lotus Domino.

It's true that there are lots of difficulties yet to be overcome, but we users should embrace these difficulties as opportunities for further development and move ahead.

Every difficulty is like a dagger. There are two ways to handle this situation: catch the dagger by the blade and get hurt, or catch it by its handle and use it as a weapon to move ahead. I would like to be in the second situation.

—**S. Bera**, Mumbai.berasomnath@gmail.com



FOSS is not just about free software, just like *Medecins Sans Frontieres* (Doctors without Borders) is not just free medicare. Both are among the noblest practically proven concepts of our time. Those who value software freedom are indebted to the selfless efforts of the FOSS community. The software-hardware racketeering of the proprietary sector is only too well known. FOSS deserves active government and private sector encouragement and support—which, we all know, is generally lacking.

In the face of all this, FOSS has been expanding and accelerating its march forward. It charts its own course as to what has to be developed and *gifted* to the world in the genuine interest of users. It is the proprietary sector that is continually watching FOSS, and not the other way around.

The proprietary sector initially chose to ignore FOSS as a *non-entity*. Today, it is too late for them to try their